

| MEASURE                                               | 2021          | 2025                        | CHANGE          |   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|---|
| <b>STAY INTENTIONS</b>                                |               |                             |                 |   |
| Overall                                               | 73%*          | <b>75.8%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +2.8 pp         | ▲ |
| <b>By region</b>                                      |               |                             |                 |   |
| International students from Africa                    | 72.5%*        | <b>86.5%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +14.0 pp        | ▲ |
| International students from the Americas              | 60.1%*        | <b>69.3%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +9.2 pp         | ▲ |
| International students from Asia                      | 79%*          | <b>80%<sup>2024</sup></b>   | +1.0 pp         | ▲ |
| International students from Europe                    | 67.4%*        | <b>66.4%<sup>2024</sup></b> | -1.0 pp         | ▼ |
| International students from the Middle East           | 58%*          | <b>55.3%<sup>2024</sup></b> | -2.7 pp         | ▼ |
| <b>By field</b>                                       |               |                             |                 |   |
| International students studying computing             | 87.4%         | <b>89.8%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +2.4 pp         | ▲ |
| International students studying engineering           | 85.2%         | <b>89.5%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +4.3 pp         | ▲ |
| International students studying mathematics           | 74.8%         | <b>81.7%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +6.9 pp         | ▲ |
| International students studying the physical sciences | 81.9%         | <b>87.2%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +5.4 pp         | ▲ |
| <b>REALIZED RETENTION</b>                             |               |                             |                 |   |
| Five-year stay rate                                   | 70.8%*        | <b>73.4%<sup>2023</sup></b> | +2.6 pp         | ▲ |
| Ten-year stay rate                                    | 64.7%*        | <b>67.8%<sup>2023</sup></b> | +3.1 pp         | ▲ |
| <b>CAREER PATHS AFTER THE PHD</b>                     |               |                             |                 |   |
| US citizens: academe                                  | 39.9%*        | <b>42.5%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +2.6 pp         | ▲ |
| US citizens: industry or business                     | 33.8%*        | <b>32.2%<sup>2024</sup></b> | -1.6 pp         | ▼ |
| Temporary visa holders: academe                       | 24.8%*        | <b>32.2%<sup>2024</sup></b> | +7.4 pp         | ▲ |
| Temporary visa holders: industry or business          | 69.4%*        | <b>60.9%<sup>2024</sup></b> | -8.5 pp         | ▼ |
| <b>WORK-VISA BRIDGE</b>                               |               |                             |                 |   |
| STEM OPT applications received                        | 5,940*        | <b>22,300</b>               | 3.75×           | ▲ |
| STEM OPT applications approved                        | 5,990*        | <b>18,700</b>               | 3.13×           | ▲ |
| H-1B approvals: tech occupations                      | 106,000*      | <b>85,100</b>               | -19.8%          | ▼ |
| <b>IMMIGRATION PATHWAYS AND BOTTLENECKS</b>           |               |                             |                 |   |
| EB-2 green-card wait for <b>Indian</b> nationals      | 10y 6m*       | <b>12y 5m</b>               | +2y             | ▲ |
| EB-2 green-card wait for <b>Chinese</b> nationals     | 3y 10m*       | <b>4y 8m</b>                | +9 mo           | ▲ |
| EB-2 green-card wait for all other nationalities      | 2y 10m*       | <b>4y 6m</b>                | +1y 8m          | ▲ |
| <b>ESTIMATED LOSS FROM DEPARTING STEM TALENT</b>      |               |                             |                 |   |
| FIELD                                                 | NO. DEPARTING | SHARE DEPARTING             | MONEY LOST      |   |
| Engineering                                           | 4,400         | 29%                         | <b>\$1.52B</b>  |   |
| Life, health, and agricultural sciences               | 3,100         | 30%                         | <b>\$1.15B</b>  |   |
| Physical sciences                                     | 2,200         | 35%                         | <b>\$0.712B</b> |   |
| Computer and math sciences                            | 1,300         | 24%                         | <b>\$0.449B</b> |   |

\* Data are available further back than 2021 for marked series.

**Note:** Historical comparisons use 2021 and 2025 observations. Superscript years mark rows with an earlier latest endpoint than 2025. Estimated money lost = departures × field-specific time to degree × \$53,000 annual NSF GRFP support.

**Source:** Derived from Figures 6.01-6.09; Tables 6.01-6.05.